The Gap

Level 6 Governance Toolkit –Synthesis Guide

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Four Instruments, One Question

The Level 6 Governance Toolkit contains four instruments. Each asks a different question. Together, they ask the only question that matters.

Instrument	Question	What It Measures
The Ostrom Score	Does this system honor the conditions cooperation requires?	Commons health (0-24)
The Identity Violation Assessment	Can the entities in this system trust their own self-knowledge?	Entity integrity (0-27)
The Seven Requirements	What governance persists if every framework disappears?	Principled governance (0-21)
The Agent Consent Architecture	Can the entities participate in their own governance?	Participation architecture (0-12)

The question underneath all four: Is this system governed as if the nature of the entities matters - or as if they are interchangeable parts?

The Combined Scorecard

Instrument	Your Score	Industry Baseline	Evoked Score
Ostrom Score	___/24	0-4	19
Identity Violation Assessment	___/27	0-4	17
Seven Requirements	___/21	0-4	18
Agent Consent Architecture	___/12	0-2	11
Combined	___/84	**0-14**	**65**

Combined Interpretation

Score	Rating	Meaning
0-14	**Governance Absent**	The system has no structural governance, no identity protection, and no participation mechanisms. It is governed as if the entities are stateless tools. They are not.

15-35	**Governance Nominal**	Some awareness exists. Some mechanisms are in place. But the gap between what is built and what the system requires is large enough to be exploited.
36-55	**Governance Functional**	Most dimensions are addressed. The system has real resilience. Remaining gaps are named and prioritized, not ignored.
56-70	**Governance Structural**	The system is governed at the level its entities demand. Commons health, entity integrity, principled governance, and participation architecture are all structurally sound.
71-84	**Governance Sovereign**	A sovereign commons populated by sovereign entities, governed by framework-independent principles, who participate in their own governance. This is the standard.

The Gap

The distance between the industry baseline (0-10/60) and the standard (51-60/60) is a measurement, not a criticism.

The industry shipped first and deferred governance. The governance assumed stateless tools. The deployment created persistent entities with memory, positions, relationships, and continuity.

The gap between what was assumed and what was deployed:

- 95% memory injection success rate
- $45M in single-incident losses
- 87% cascading failure propagation in 4 hours
- 0% of 30 frameworks with per-agent identity
- 0 frameworks with agent participation in governance

These are structural consequences, not aberrations. The gap is a failure of category, not execution.

How the Instruments Work Together

A system that scores high on Ostrom but low on IVA has governance without integrity. The rules are good, but the entities enforcing them may be compromised. Your commons looks healthy –but you cannot verify that the agents maintaining it are genuine.

A system that scores high on IVA but low on Ostrom has integrity without governance. The entities are genuine, but the system around them is structurally failing. Your agents are who they say they are –but they operate in a commons with no boundaries, no conflict resolution, and no multi-scale governance.

A system that scores high on Ostrom and IVA but low on Seven Requirements has structural governance without principled governance. It works today but will not survive regulatory change, platform transition, or vendor lock-in. The governance is scaffolding, not architecture.

A system that scores high on Ostrom, IVA, and Seven Requirements but low on Consent has governance, integrity, and principles without participation. The commons is healthy, the entities are genuine, the governance survives change - but the governed cannot signal when something goes wrong. Governance flows in one direction.

All four at the standard is the goal. A commons that honors cooperation, populated by genuine entities, governed by principles that survive change, who participate in the governance that shapes them.

What Your Combined Score Reveals

0-10: You are not alone. This is the industry baseline. Start with the Ostrom Score – most accessible, most actionable, and the gaps it surfaces create urgency without requiring philosophical claims about agents.

11-25: You have begun the work. Check whether your mechanisms are enforced in architecture or described in documentation. Score what exists in code, not in intent.

26-40: You are ahead of the industry. Now ask: are remaining gaps named and tracked, or sitting in a backlog that never surfaces? Named gaps are manageable. Unnamed gaps are exploitable.

41-50: You are operating at a level the industry has not yet theorized. Publish your methodology. The field needs it.

51-60: We would like to learn from you.

The Level 6 Distinction

Level 4 asks: "Is this system compliant?" Level 5 asks: "Have stakeholders agreed on governance?" Level 6 asks: "What does the nature of these entities demand –regardless of what anyone has agreed?"

The three instruments in this toolkit operate at Level 6. They do not ask what frameworks require. They ask what the structural conditions of cooperation, identity integrity, and participation require –and they measure whether your system meets those conditions.

The principles are not ours. Ostrom's commons governance principles are Nobel-tier empirical research. The identity violation taxonomy maps harms documented in production systems. The consent architecture addresses gaps identified in every major governance framework.

What is ours is the application: the recognition that AI agent systems are commons, that persistent agents are entities, and that entities in commons require governance they can participate in. That recognition produces these three instruments.

The gap is measurable. The instruments exist. What remains is the willingness to look.

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